

SEWING ON A ZIP



1 The easiest method for sewing on a zip is centring it on an opening in a seamline. To begin, machine stitch the seamline, leaving a gap in the stitches that is the length of the zip.



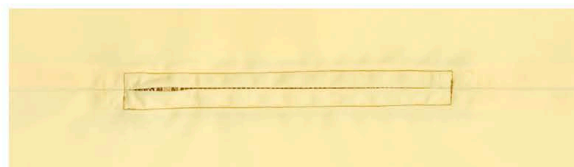
2 Tack the opening closed, working the tacking stitches along the seamline.



3 Open out the seam and press the seam allowance open on the wrong side. Open the zip and place it face down on top of the wrong side of the seam. Centring the zip teeth carefully on top of the seam, tack one side of the zip tape in place 3mm (1/8in) from the teeth.



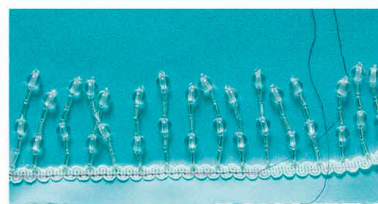
4 Close the zip and tack the other side of the zip tape in place. Using a matching thread, machine stitch the zip in place, stitching on the right side of the fabric and forming a rectangle around the zip just outside the tacking stitches.



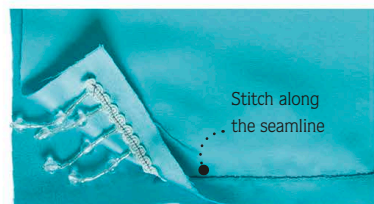
5 Remove the tacking around the zip tape and along the opening. Press.

▶ INSERTING TRIM IN A SEAM

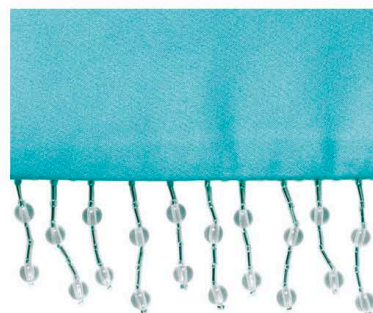
If a piece is backed, trims, in addition to piping (see p.139), can be inserted between the top and the other layer, such as in the seam joining the front and back of a cushion or place mat.



1 Measure the edge to be trimmed and add an extra 10–15cm (4–6in) to the trimming. Starting in the centre of the bottom edge on the right side of the top, align the top edge of the trim on the seamline with the decorative edge pointing away from the raw edge. Pin and tack, then machine stitch in place.



2 With the trim inside and pointing inwards, position the back and top right sides facing. Machine stitch along the same seamline that was made in Step 1.



3 Turn through to the right side and press on both sides. Topstitch along the edge if desired.